ISSUER REVIEW · 6M2026

Maxima Grupė

OK

Lithuania · Food retail (Lithuania, Latvia, Estonia; e-grocery Barbora)

Position OK. Maxima is the largest Baltic food retailer, rated BB+ (stable) by S&P[2]. 1H EBITDA EUR 169.9m, net debt / EBITDA 2.0x[3,4]. To watch: large payouts to the shareholder cut equity to EUR 147m[5]; a competition investigation is under way in Latvia[6].

REVENUE · 6M2026	EBITDA · 6M2026
2,026.4 EUR m	169.9 EUR m
▲ 2.8 % vs 6M2025	▲ 0.4 % vs 6M2025
NET DEBT / EBITDA · 6M2026	**EQUITY · 6M2026**
2.0 x	147.4 EUR m
▲ 0.5x vs FY2025	▼ 43.9 % vs FY2025

Quick summary

- **Revenue up, profitability stable:** 1H revenue EUR 2,026m (+2.8%, own calculation), EBITDA EUR 169.9m (169.2m), net profit EUR 85.7m[7].
- **Baltics only:** the Polish and Bulgarian businesses were sold in December 2025; 498 stores in Lithuania, Latvia and Estonia plus Barbora remain[8].
- **Large payouts to the shareholder:** EUR 423.9m of dividends in 2025, and in 1H 2026 EUR 101.0m of dividends plus a EUR 100m capital reduction; equity fell from EUR 572.9m to EUR 147.4m[5].
- **Higher debt:** net debt (incl. leases) EUR 764.5m, 2.0x EBITDA (end-2025: EUR 557.1m, 1.5x)[4,9].

Key facts

ISSUER RATING
S&P BB+, stable outlook (issuer and the 2031 notes; confirmed 2025-12-12)[1,2]

ANALYSIS DATE
2026-10-22

NEXT REPORT
9M 2026 results - expected November 2026

COUNTRY
Lithuania

Securities held

Maxima Grupė 4.750% senior unsecured notes 2031
XS3366323072 · 4.75% · 2031-05-19
no separate rating found

01 Instruments held and ISINs

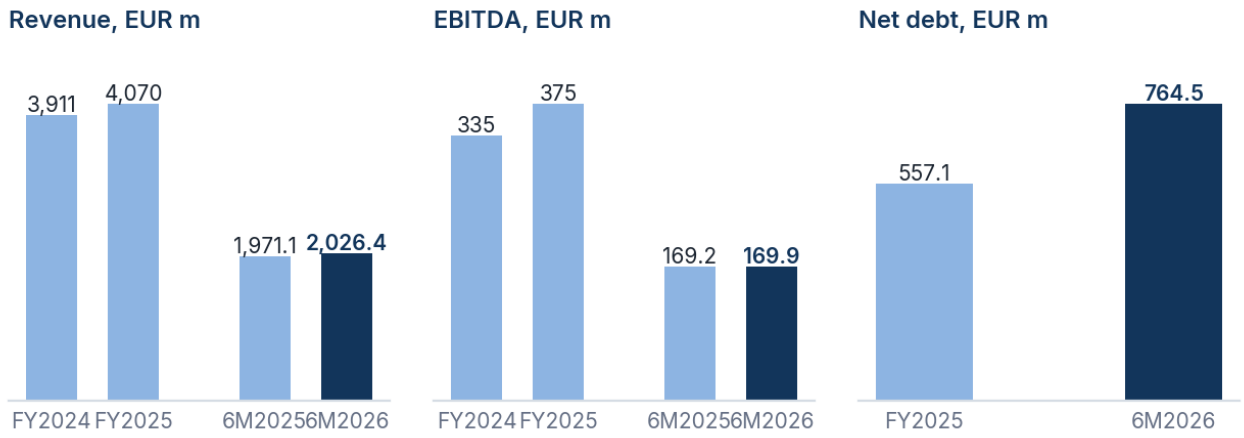
ISIN	INSTRUMENT	COUPON	MATURITY	ISSUE RATING	NOTE
XS3366323072	Maxima Grupė 4.750% senior unsecured notes 2031	4.75%	2031-05-19	no separate rating found	EMTN; unsecured; S&P BB+

02 Key ratios

METRIC	FY2025	6M2026	CHANGE
Revenue, EUR m[10,11]	4,070*	2,026.4*	▲ 2.8 % vs 6M2025
EBITDA, EUR m[10,3]	375*	169.9*	▲ 0.4 % vs 6M2025
Net profit, EUR m[12,11]	208.7ᶜ	85.7*	▲ 55.0 % vs 6M2025
Investments, EUR m[9,13]	74.3*	48.4*	▼ 32.7 % vs 6M2025
Net debt, EUR m[9,4]	557.1*	764.5*	▲ 37.2 % vs FY2025
Net debt / EBITDA[9,4]	1.5x*	2.0x*	▲ 0.5x vs FY2025
Equity, EUR m[11]	262.9*	147.4*	▼ 43.9 % vs FY2025
Equity ratio[11]	15.2%ᶜ	8.4%ᶜ	▼ 6.8 p. p. vs FY2025
Total assets, EUR m[11]	1,725.7*	1,763.8*	▲ 2.2 % vs FY2025

Colours: green change – the metric is improving, red – worsening. Latest-period cell background: green – good level, amber – average, red – weak (internal benchmarks, config/metric_rules.yaml).

* – taken from the report summary; ᶜ – own calculation. Small numbers next to text link to the source (opens the document at the cited page).



03 Business performance review

- **Strategy is price leadership in the Baltics:** 1H price cuts on 9,000 products in Lithuania and 4,000 in Latvia; more than 80 stores to be opened or expanded by 2030[14,4].
- Latvian property company Irbis A was bought on 2026-05-31 (EUR 16.9m); SOLLO was sold on 2026-08-31[15].

04 Financials

- FY2025 (continuing operations) revenue EUR 4,070m, EBITDA EUR 375m, margin 9.2%[10].
- Cash EUR 256.3m at 2026-06-30; bank loans EUR 259.3m (EUR 260m SEB/ING bridge loan, plus EUR 40m Swedbank and EUR 40m SEB)[16,8].

05 Past plans vs outcomes

PLAN / TARGET	OUTCOME	WHAT CHANGED AND WHY	STATUS
Focus on the Baltics by selling Poland and Bulgaria	Sale completed on 2025-12-19 and 2025-12-22[17,18]	Done[17].	**Met**
Refinance the short-term loan with bonds	EUR 350m of bonds issued in May 2026; most of the proceeds repay the loan[2,19]	Done[2].	**Met**
Cut Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 42% by 2030 (vs 2021)	Down 24.5% by end-2025[20]	In progress[20].	**In progress**
Open or expand >80 stores by 2030	New target[14]	New plan[14].	**In progress**

06 Investor information & conclusions

- **Instrument held:** 4.750% unsecured notes, EUR 350m, issued 2026-05-19, maturing 2031-05-19, annual coupon; Nasdaq Vilnius and Euronext Dublin; S&P BB+[21,2,19].
- **Leverage:** net debt / EBITDA 2.0x – moderate; cash of EUR 256m[4,11]. No other bonds – the 2022 6.25% bonds were redeemed early on 2025-10-27[22].
- **Risk:** large payouts to the shareholder reduce the capital buffer; no dividend policy found. Call terms and covenants were not found in the reports.
- **Conclusion:** moderate risk – stable business and a BB+ rating, but the shareholder takes out a lot of cash.

07 Market and environment

- **Price cuts and costs:** revenue +2.8% to EUR 2.03bn (like-for-like +2.1%), ahead of Baltic food inflation (about 2%)[4]. Regular prices were cut on 9,000 products in Lithuania and 4,000 in Latvia[4].
- **Margin:** EBITDA EUR 169.9m (+0.7m), margin 8.4% (-0.2 pp) mainly due to rising wage, energy and fuel costs, offset by efficiency gains[4].
- **By country:** Lithuania +4.6%, Latvia +0.6%, Estonia +1.3%, Barbora +0.4%[4].

	NOW	3 MONTHS AGO	12 MONTHS AGO	12-MONTH CHANGE
ECB deposit facility rate	2.50% (2026-09)	2.25%	–	–
3-month Euribor	2.64% (2026-09)	2.34%	2.03%	▲ 0.61 p. p.
6-month Euribor	2.92% (2026-09)	2.60%	2.10%	▲ 0.82 p. p.
12-month Euribor	3.25% (2026-09)	2.80%	2.17%	▲ 1.08 p. p.
Euro area AAA government 10-year yield	3.38% (2026-10)	3.23%	2.72%	▲ 0.66 p. p.
Euro area inflation (HICP, annual)	1.90% (2025-12)	2.20%	2.40%	▼ 0.50 p. p.

Euro area rates and inflation (ECB data, end-of-month value; Euribor and inflation – monthly average). Relevant for floating-rate and reset bonds and refinancing costs.

08 In the press

- **Real estate:** on 2026-10-09 Maxima LT bought a building and plot in Vilnius for EUR 5.5m[23].

Automatic news scan (Google News, LT, LV), 2026-07-25 – 2026-10-23: 10 articles.

2026-10-09	DEAL	„Maxima“ įsigijo daugiau nei 62 arų sklypą Vilniuje: svarsto, ką jame įrengti 15min.lt · 1 more similar articles
2026-10-19	OTHER	“Maxima” sadarbībā ar Veselīga uztura kustību “Ēstprieks” sāk ražot īpaši bērniem radītas maltītes Jauns.lv
2026-10-12	OTHER	Zemi Gulbenē, Brīvības ielā, pērk SIA "Maxima Latvija" firma Dzirkstele.lv
2026-10-11	OTHER	“Diētiskā versija?” Sieviete nopērk “Maxima” eklērus un ir pārsteigta par to, ko tajos atrod LA.LV
2026-10-01	OTHER	„Maxima“ Latvijoje mažina kainas: pirkėjai šių produktų kainą pastebės iš karto Kaipkada.lt
2026-09-30	OTHER	Kam šoreiz masveidā samazinātas cenas “Maxima” veikalos? Jauns.lv
2026-09-30	OTHER	Priecīgas ziņas Latvijas iedzīvotājiem: "Maxima" paziņo, ka turpmāk vairāki pircēju iecienīti produkti maksās ievērojami lētāk Dzentlmenis.lv
2026-09-25	OTHER	Alūksnes novada mazpulcēnu izaudzētie sīpoli nonāk “Maxima” veikalu plauktos Aluksniesiem.lv
2026-09-24	OTHER	Vairāk nekā 6 tonnas mazpulcēnu audzēto sīpolu pieejami “Maxima” veikalos ZiemeļLatvija.lv

09 ESG report

EXCLUSIONARY SCREENING (COMPANIES)

- ✓ **Yes, the company is not involved in excluded sectors: controversial and nuclear weapons, tobacco, gambling and restricted sectors in fossil fuel**
  - Food retail
  - No activity in excluded sectors[1].

- ✓ **Yes, the company does not have red flag/signal related to controversies based on UN Global Compact, OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises or any other relevant principles/standards**
  - No UN Global Compact or OECD related controversies found.

- ✓ **Yes, the company is not in the list of sanctions (add a screenshot)**
  - Not found on the EU, UN, UK, US OFAC consolidated sanctions lists (automatic check 2026-10-23).
  - Namesake on the lists: Maxima LLC – an alias in an EU-list entry for a different company (linked to Dalpribor), not Maxima Grupė UAB.
  - Namesake on the lists: Maxima Legal LLC – an alias in the same EU-list entry, not Maxima Grupė UAB.

  Manual check
  - OFAC sanctions search[24]
  - EU Sanctions Map[25]
  - SEB eNameChecker (internal SEB system).

– **Yes, issues were not identified from adverse media checks (add a screenshot)**
- Found: on 2025-11-06 the Latvian Competition Council fined Maxima Latvija more than EUR 1.8m for unfair trading practices
- The company disagrees and appeals[26].
- On 2026-02-26 the Council took procedural actions at Maxima Latvija's office over a suspected cartel between the two largest retailers
- The investigation is ongoing, no fine yet[6].
- News summary 2026-07-25 – 2026-10-23: 10 articles, 0 with an adverse keyword in the headline (details in the section "In the press").

In case any red flags, risks, unclarities were identified then additional checks (sanctions screening and adverse media checks) on the company's Ultimate Beneficial Owners and/or senior management shall be performed.

Additional comments:

ESG INTEGRATION AND POSITIVE SCREENING (POSITIVE ANSWERS IMPLY HIGHER ALLOCATION)

✓ **Yes, the company is promoting environmental or social characteristics (activities, ESG policy, good ESG rating, etc)**
- Renewable energy 37.1% (2025), 85% of waste diverted from landfill, food donations to food banks (EUR 6.3m)[20].

✓ **Yes, the activities of the company or it's strategy is aligned with the taxonomy and/or Paris agreement targets (e.g. net zero commitment)**
- Target to cut Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 42% by 2030 (vs 2021)
- 24.5% achieved[20].

– **Yes, the company does not have yellow flag/signal related to controversies based on UN Global Compact or any other relevant principles/standards**
- Yellow flag: Latvian competition fine and cartel investigation[26,6].

✓ **Yes, the company fulfills the expectations from SEB thematic and sector policies**

Applicable
- The Agriculture policy (food trading)[27].

Met
- A sustainability report in the annual report, an emission reduction target[28].

Additional comments:

ENGAGEMENT

– **Is there a need for pro-active engagement with the company?**
- No need: the competition matters are being handled in court and in the investigation.

Additional comments:

INDICATORS

✓ **Yes, the indicators of the company support the targets of sustainability and PAI indicators followed by the Fund**
- Emissions, renewable energy share and waste figures are reported[20].

Additional comments:

Conclusion: No exclusions or red flags. Yellow flag – competition law matters in Latvia.

SEB policies applied: Policy on Sustainability Considerations in Investments (SEB AB); Agriculture, Fishing, Aquaculture and Animal Welfare sector policy; Environmental Policy on Climate, Nature and Water (thematic); Social and Human Rights Policy (thematic); Governance expectations in sector policies (anti-corruption, tax, reporting)

10 Sources

1. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 6, 2026-04-07
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3. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 7, 2026-09-04
4. Maxima Grupė - Press release: 2026 m. pirmasis pusmetis, 2026-09-04
5. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 3-4, 9, 2026-09-04
6. LSM - Cartel suspected between two food retailers in Latvia, 2026-02-27
7. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 3, 7, 2026-09-04
8. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 5-6, 2026-04-07
9. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 8, 2026-04-07
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14. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 10, 2026-04-07
15. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated interim condensed financial statements 6M 2026 (unaudited, LT), p. 9-10, 2026-09-04
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21. Maxima Grupė - Bond issue page, 2026
22. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 4-5, 2026-04-07
23. tv3.lt – „Maxima LT“ už 5,5 mln. eurų įsigijo pastatą ir sklypą Vilniuje, 2026-10-09
24. OFAC Sanctions List Search (US Treasury)
25. EU Sanctions Map
26. LSM - Maxima Latvia hit with EUR 1.8 million fine for unfair trading practices, 2025-11-06
27. SEB Agriculture, Fishing, Aquaculture and Animal Welfare sector policy (2026-04-23), p. 5-10, 2026-04-23
28. Maxima Grupė - Consolidated management report 2025 (LT), p. 3, 53-97, 2026-04-07

Report prepared from public sources. Figures are as published by the issuer; small numbers next to the text point to the source list.